

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Alternative Investments Legal Assistant role at Ryder Reid Legal appeals to me because it sits at the intersection of investment funds work and the kind of structured, deadline-driven legal support I have been building toward through both my BCLP placement and recent self-directed study of private equity and fund structures.

At BCLP I spent six months in International Arbitration, where I became the only junior supporting the team in the run-up to a significant submission deadline. I coordinated documents across the matter, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery of the Claimant's memorial. The other six months I spent in Real Estate Disputes, preparing electronic hearing bundles, assisting with skeleton arguments and managing large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines. Both rotations required the kind of organised, accurate file management that legal assistant work in a busy funds team demands, and I received feedback from a partner and associate that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

My interest in private equity and fund structures developed more recently. Attending an A&O Shearman open day in August 2026 exposed me to how different practice areas contribute to a PE transaction, including how lenders take security and how financing is structured across asset classes. That session prompted me to take a Coursera course on private equity after the event, where I studied fund structures, investment selection, leverage, value creation and exit strategies. I then applied some of those concepts in a practical context through the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance virtual experience programme. I mention this because the interest is real and recent, and this role is a practical next step in developing it properly.

My LLM at Queen Mary in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution, currently finishing, has strengthened my legal research and document analysis skills, and my ongoing advisory work at Citizens Advice East Berkshire has kept me working on live matters with real clients, managing files, drafting correspondence and meeting deadlines independently.

I want to work in a funds team specifically because it would let me develop substantive knowledge of alternative investments while building on the document management, drafting and coordination work I have already done at a City firm.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva